

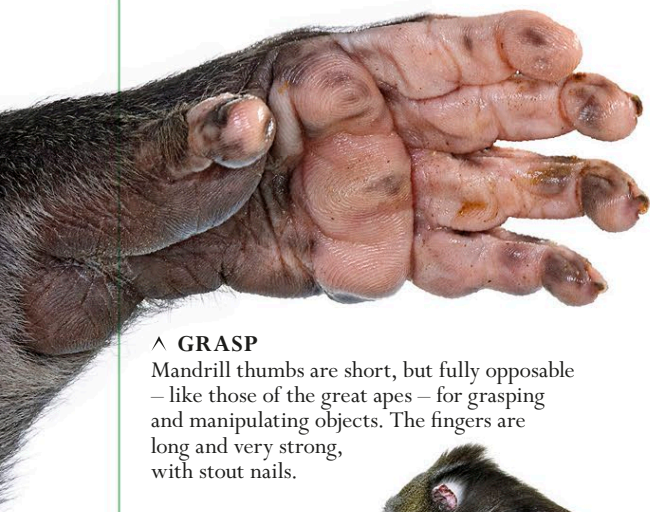
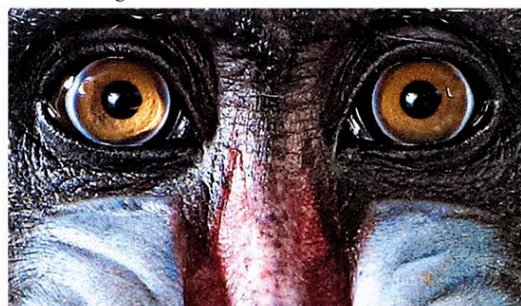
# MANDRILL

## *Mandrillus sphinx*

The mandrill is the largest of all monkeys, and the male is particularly spectacular. Mandrills live in troops that usually contain a dominant male, several females, a gaggle of youngsters, and various non-breeding, lower-ranking males. Sometimes several groups merge to form troops of 200 or more. Mandrill society has a strict hierarchy. Individuals advertise their status with colourful patches of skin on the face and rump. A dominant male is fearsome-looking, and he has a temperament to match. The brightness of the skin pigments is controlled by hormones and colour is a good indicator of strength and ferocity. A rival must be very sure of himself before challenging such a magnificent animal, and serious fights tend to occur only between well-matched individuals.

### ✓ LONG, HARD GLARE

Forward-facing eyes provide the mandrill with stereoscopic vision. They see in full colour, which helps them to locate ripe fruit and to distinguish the visual signals of other individuals.

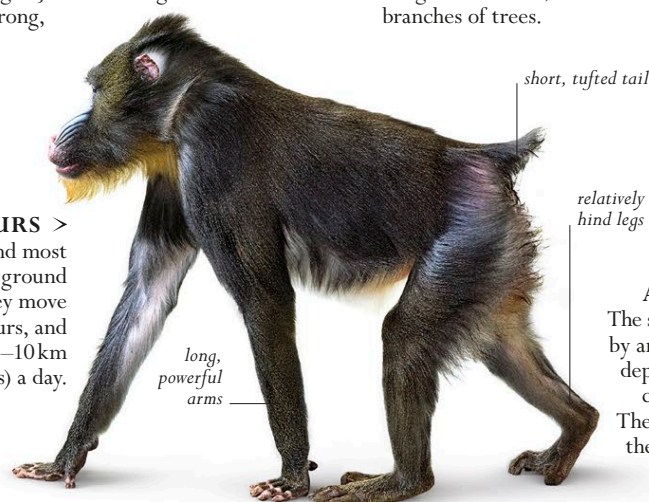


### ^ GRASP

Mandrill thumbs are short, but fully opposable – like those of the great apes – for grasping and manipulating objects. The fingers are long and very strong, with stout nails.

### ALL FOURS >

Mandrills spend most of their time at ground level, where they move about on all fours, and typically roam 5–10 km (3–6 miles) a day.



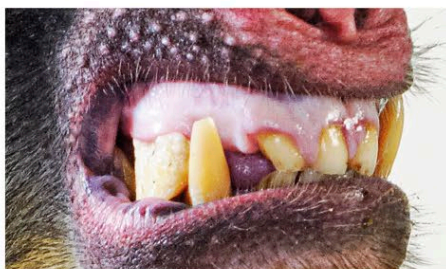
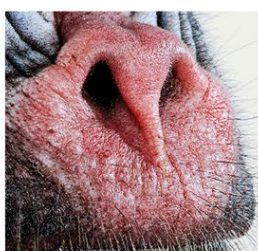
short, tufted tail

relatively short hind legs

long, powerful arms

### < NOSTRILS

In a mature male, the skin around the nostrils and the centre of the snout is scarlet. Females and young mandrills have a black nose.



### ^ HIND FEET

The hind feet resemble the hands, in that the toes are long and able to grasp. Mandrills are good climbers, and often sleep among the branches of trees.

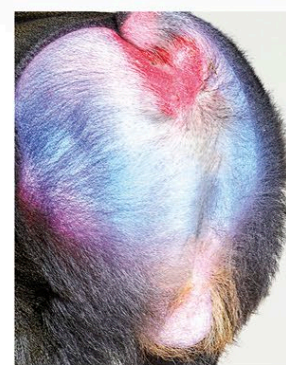
### < TEETH

The long canine teeth are used principally for fighting and in display. The cheek teeth are smaller, with knobbly surfaces, which are used for grinding up plant material.



### ^ PLAIN RUMP

All mandrills have a hairless rump and a short tail. The rump of the subordinate male has less colour than the alpha male.



grooves on either side of the nose



**SIZE** 55–110 cm (22–43 in)

**HABITAT** Dense rainforest

**DISTRIBUTION** Western Central Africa, from S. Cameroon to S.W. Republic of Congo

**DIET** Mainly fruit